CARL MÜLLER-CREPON

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Assistant Professor at the London School of Economics and Political Science

RESEARCH INTEREST

I use innovative quantitative methods to study state building, ethnic politics and their consequences for development and conflict in modern Europe and 20th century Africa.

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

London School of Economics and Political Science, United Kingdom — Sept. 2022 –
Assistant Professor, Department of Government
Associate Member, LSE Data Science Institute

University of Oxford, United Kingdom — July 2020 – Aug. 2022
Departmental Lecturer in International Relations, Department of Politics and International Relations
College Tutor, St. Hilda's College
Associate Member, Nuffield College

ETH Zurich, Switzerland — July 2019 – July 2020
Postdoctoral Researcher, International Conflict Research Group

Harvard University, Cambridge MA, USA — Feb. 2020 – Sept. 2020
Postdoctoral Visiting Researcher, Institute for Quantitative Social Science

EDUCATION

ETH Zurich, Switzerland — Apr. 2015 – May 2019
PhD in Political Science
State Building, Development and Conflict in 20th Century Africa
Committee: Lars-Erik Cederman (main supervisor), Simon Hug, Horacio A. Larreguy

Harvard University, Cambridge MA, USA — Feb. 2017 – Dec. 2017
Economics Department Visiting Affiliate

ETH Zurich and University of Zurich, Switzerland — Mar. 2015
MA in Comparative and International Studies (MACIS)

University of St. Gallen, Switzerland — July 2012
BA in Economics & BA in International Affairs
Exchange semester at Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Book

1. Cederman, Lars-Erik, Luc Girardin, Carl Müller-Crepon & Yannick Pengl (2025). Nationalism and the Transformation of the State: Border Change and Political Violence in the Modern World. *Cambridge University Press*.

Journal articles

Online first

20. Müller-Crepon, Carl (2026). Ethnic Geography and the Colonial Design of Administrative Units in Sub-Saharan Africa. *Comparative Political Studies*, OnlineFirst.

19. Müller-Crepon, Carl & Nils-Christian Bormann (2026). Coethnics Covote in Africa: Studying Electoral Cleavages with a Covoting Regression Model. *American Political Science Review*, FirstView.

18. Müller-Crepon, Carl, Clara Neupert-Wentz, Andrej Kokkonen & Jørgen Møller (2026). Rulers on the Road: Itinerant Rule in the Holy Roman Empire, AD 919–1519. *American Journal of Political Science*, Early View.

17. Dawson, Stephen, Felix Haass, Carl Müller-Crepon & Aksel Sundström (2025). The Ethnic Politics of Nature Protection. *Journal of Politics*, Online First.

In print

16. Pengl, Yannick, Carl Müller-Crepon, Roberto Valli, Lars-Erik Cederman & Luc Girardin (2026). The Train Wrecks of Modernization: Railway Construction and Nationalist Mobilization in Europe. *American Political Science Review, 120*(1), 37–54.

15. Dill, Janina, Marnie Howlett & Carl Müller-Crepon (2026). Do Ukrainians Still Prefer Self-Defense Against Russia At Any Cost? *Journal of Peace Research, 63*(2), 269–278.

14. Müller-Crepon, Carl (2025). Building Tribes: How Administrative Units Shaped Ethnic Groups in Africa. *American Journal of Political Science, 69*(2), 406–422.

13. Müller-Crepon, Carl, Guy Schvitz & Lars-Erik Cederman (2025). Shaping States into Nations: The Effects of Ethnic Geography on State Borders. *American Journal of Political Science, 69*,(1), 132–147.

12. Müller-Crepon, Carl, Guy Schvitz & Lars-Erik Cederman (2025). 'Right-Peopling' the State: Nationalism, Historical Legacies and Ethnic Cleansing in Europe, 1885-2020. *Journal of Conflict Resolution, 69*(2-3), 211–241.

11. Dill, Janina, Marnie Howlett & Carl Müller-Crepon (2024). At Any Cost: How Ukrainians Think about Self-Defense Against Russia. *American Journal of Political Science, 68*(4), 1460–1478.

10. Cederman, Lars-Erik, Yannick Pengl, Luc Girardin & Carl Müller-Crepon (2024). The Future is History: Restorative Nationalism and Conflict in Post-Napoleonic Europe. *International Organization, 78*(2), 259–292.

9. Neupert-Wentz, Clara & Carl Müller-Crepon (2024). Traditional Institutions in Africa, Past and Present. *Political Science Research and Methods, 12*(2), 267–284.

8. Cederman, Lars-Erik, Luc Girardin & Carl Müller-Crepon (2023). Nationalism and the Puzzle of Reversing State Size. *World Politics, 75*(4), 692–734.

7. Müller-Crepon, Carl (2023). State Reach and Development in Africa since the 1960s: New Data and Analysis. *Political Science Research and Methods, 11*(3), 663–672.

6. Müller-Crepon, Carl, Yannick Pengl & Nils-Christian Bormann (2022). Linking Ethnic Data from Africa. *Journal of Peace Research, 59*(3), 425–435.

5. Müller-Crepon, Carl (2022). Local Ethno-Political Polarization and Election Violence in Majoritarian vs. Proportional Systems. *Journal of Peace Research, 59*(2), 242–258.

4. Müller-Crepon, Carl, Philipp Hunziker & Lars-Erik Cederman (2021). Roads to Rule, Roads to Rebellion: Relational State Capacity and Conflict in Africa. *Journal of Conflict Resolution, 65*(2-3), 563–590.

3. Beiser-McGrath, Janina, Carl Müller-Crepon & Yannick Pengl (2021). Who Benefits? How Local Ethnic Demography Shapes Political Favoritism in Africa. *British Journal of Political Science, 51*(4), 1582–1600.

2. Müller-Crepon, Carl (2020). Continuity or Change: (In)direct rule in British and French Colonial Africa. *International Organization, 74*(4), 707–741.

1. Müller-Crepon, Carl & Philipp Hunziker (2018). New Spatial Data on Ethnicity: Introducing SIDE. *Journal of Peace Research, 55*(5), 687–698. *JPR Best Visualization Award 2018.*

WORKING PAPERS

3. Dill, Janina, Marnie Howlett, Carl Müller-Crepon & Mara Revkin. Fate or Choice? Attitudes Toward Collaboration and Reintegration in Ukraine. *Journal of Politics*, Revise & Resubmit.

2. Rickard, Kit, Marnie Howlett, Anton Hrushetsky & Carl Müller-Crepon. The Geography of Territorial Preferences: Evidence from Wartime Ukraine.

1. Valli, Roberto & Carl Müller-Crepon. How Border Change Shifts Languages: Evidence from Europe, 1815–1938.

SOFTWARE PACKAGES

`CVReg`: Covoting Regression Model and associated methods, in `R`

`hegdata`: Data on Historical Ethnic Geography in Europe, in `R`

`cjRank`: Ranking of attribute features and nested marginal means for conjoint experiments, in `R`

`pspm`: Estimation of Probabilistic Spatial Partition Models, in `R`

`SpatialLattice`: Setting up and handling spatial graph data, in `R`

`LEDA`: Linking Ethnic Data from Africa, in `R`

`SIDE`: Compositional spatial data on ethnicity, in `R`

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

European Research Council, Starting Grant (PI; EUR 1'500'000) Jan. 2026 — Dec. 2030
BORDERS: Border Change and Local Development in Europe and Beyond

Swedish Research Council, Research Project Grant (Co-I; SEK 5'000'000) Jan. 2024 — Dec. 2026
On the road again: The rise and decline of itinerant rule.

LSE Department of Government Group Seed Grant (PI; GBP 5'850) July 2023 – July 2024
The Space to Belong to: Understanding Individuals' Perceptions of Community within Multiethnic Settings (*returned*)

John Fell Fund Grant (Co-PI; GBP 10'000) Feb. 2022 – July 2022
Imagined Cartographies: A Survey Experiment on Territorial Border Preferences

Leverhulme Small Research Grant (GBP 9'939) Sept. 2021 – June 2023
Cracking or Packing Ethnic Groups? The Colonial Design of Administrative Units in Sub-Saharan Africa

Doc.CH grant (CHF 208'301) Mar. 2016 – Sept. 2019
PhD grant of the Swiss National Science Foundation

Doc.Mobility grant (CHF 12'760) Feb. 2017 – Dec. 2017
Mobility grant of the Swiss National Science Foundation

ETH Medal Dec. 2015
Awarded for MA thesis entitled *Ethno-Political Competition and Pre-Election Violence in Africa*.

Scholarship of the German National Academic Foundation (EUR 10'200) Feb. 2010 – Mar. 2015

ETH Zurich Master Scholarship (CHF 17'000) Sept. 2013 – Mar. 2015

Carlo-Schmid Fellowship (EUR 10'800) Sept. 2012 – Feb. 2013
Fellowship at the United Nations' Department for Economic and Social Affairs

Arthur Rich Award (CHF 2'000) May 2013
Awarded for an excellent BA thesis on ethical issues at the University of St. Gallen

TEACHING

Evaluation scores (ES): 5=best, 1=worst

Ethnic Politics and Conflict Spring 2026–
LSE, MSc Political Science (ES 4.7; previously: *The Politics of Ethnicity*)

Introduction to Comparative Politics and Conflict Studies Fall 2023–
LSE, MSc Political Science (ES 4.5)

War, Power, and Morality: Divisive Debates and Contentious Conflicts Summer 2024–
LSE, Summer School (ES 4.6)

Comparative Conflict Analysis Fall 2022
LSE, MSc Conflict Analysis (ES 4.4)

Research Design and Methods Practical Sessions Fall 2020, 2021
University of Oxford, MPhil International Relations (ES 4.5)

Thesis Seminar (co-taught) Fall 2020, 2021
University of Oxford, MPhil International Relations

The Development of the International System and Contemporary Debates in IR Theory Fall 2020
University of Oxford, MPhil International Relations core course (ES 4.7)

Undergraduate Tutoring Fall 2020–
University of Oxford (ES 4.5): *Practice of Politics*; *International Relations core course*; *International Security*

Political Economy of Development and Conflict in Africa (with Yannick Pengl) Fall 2019
ETH Zurich, graduate course (ES 4.9)

Ethnic conflict from a political science perspective (with Yannick Pengl) Summer 2017
German National Academic Foundation summer school, undergraduate course (ES 4.4)

Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Methods Fall 2015
ETH Zurich, graduate course by Liam McGrath and Jørgen Bølstad

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Political Economy Fall 2014, 2015
University of Zurich, undergraduate course by Prof. Katharina Michaelowa

SUPERVISION AND MENTORING

Post-doctoral researchers:
Alejandro López Peceño, 2026– (PhD New York University)
Natalia Vasilenok, 2026– (PhD Stanford)

PhD students
External examiner: Thomas Nawrath (Hertie School Berlin, expected 2027)
Host for visiting exchanges: Thomas Nawrath (Hertie School Berlin), Laura Howell (Princeton University)

NON-ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

Kiel Institute for the World Economy Mar. 2013 – July 2013
Research internship on migration and development

United Nations Department for Social and Economic Affairs Sept. 2012 – Feb. 2013
Carlo-Schmid Fellow at the Office for Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) Support and Coordination, Policy Coordination Branch

Coordination Régionale des Artisans de Ségou, Mali Aug. 2008 – July 2009
Voluntary service through the *weltwärts* program of the German Development Service

PRESENTATIONS

Invited

2027: Princeton University*; Institute for Advanced Study in Toulouse*; Harvard Radcliffe Institute*

2026: University of Bristol; University of Oxford; IE University Madrid;

2025: EUI Florence; IBEI Barcelona; MIT Global Diversity Lab; University College London; University of Bath

2024: NYU Abu Dhabi (declined due to parental leave)

2023: University College London; University of Barcelona, IPErG; LSE African Political Economy and IR Seminars

2022: University of Oxford & Nuffield College; London School of Economics and Political Science; Ohio State University

2021: University of Essex

2020: Washington University in St. Louis

2019: Graduate Institute Geneva

* scheduled

Conferences

APSA Annual Meeting: 2017–2021, 2024, 2025

EPSA Annual Meeting: 2019, 2022–2024

EPSS Annual Meeting: 2026

MPSA Annual Conference: 2017, 2020

ISA Annual Convention: 2016, 2022

Swiss Political Science Association: 2017, 2020, 2026

Workshops

2026: Computational Methods in Conflict and Peace Research (University of Milan); Uses and Abuses of the Murdock Atlas in Social Science Research (LSE)

2025: Historical Political Economy Scoping Workshop; Future of disaggregated conflict research (PRIO Oslo)

2024: Interdisciplinary Workshop on Identity and Politics (IAST/TSE)

2023: Conflict, Peace & Security Hub, University of Oxford

2021: Borders and Boundaries Conference (University of Pennsylvania)

2020: Border Science Exploratory Seminar (Harvard Radcliffe Institute)

pre-2020: Empirical Peace and Conflict Research (2016, 2018); 3rd Witten Conference on Institutional Change (2016); European Network of Conflict Research (2015, 2016); graduate student workshops at ETH and Harvard University

SERVICE

Committees Internal: Research Committee (2025–), Doctoral Programme Committee (2025–), Student Engagement Committee (2022–2025)

External: Journal of Peace Research Editorial Committee, PolMeth Europe Paper Selection Committee (2025)

Co-Organizer Internal: LSE Comparative Politics Research Seminar (2026–); Early Career Researcher Lunch (2025–); LSE African Political Economy Seminar (2023–2026); LSE Political Science and Political Economy Seminar Series (2023–2025); Oxford IR Colloquium (2021–2022); Oxford DPIR Politics Research Colloquium (2021); Political Economy Seminar, ETH Zurich (2018); Conflict Colloquium, ETH Zurich (2018)

External: Politics of the Global South Workshop (2024–)

Reviewer Journals: American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, British Journal of Political Science, Comparative Political Studies, Conflict Management and Peace Science, Economic Systems, European Review of Economic History, International Journal of Comparative Sociology, International Organization, International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Development Studies, Journal of Peace Research, Journal of Politics, Nationalities Papers, Nations and Nationalism, Political Analysis, Political Geography, Political Science Research and Methods, Research and Politics, Public Opinion Quarterly, Texas National Security Review, World Politics

Presses: Oxford University Press

Grants: European Research Council, Economic and Social Research Council

OTHERS

Languages English, German (mother tongue), Swiss German, Spanish, French

Software R, Stata, Python, PostgreSQL, ArcGIS, QGIS

October, 2026